



Hotel reception • Photo: JIP, Wikimedia Commons, CC BY-SA 4.0

1

Hear

Listen fully

2

Empathise

Show understanding

3

Apologise

Sincerely

4

Resolve

Fix or escalate

5

Diagnose

Log the cause

Say	Avoid
"I am sorry about the noise. Let me solve this now."	"That is not our fault."
"Thank you for telling me."	"You should have told us earlier."
"Here is what I can do for you."	"That is the policy."
"I will check and call you back by 16:00."	"Not my department."

Authority ladder



Limits are set by hotel policy. Escalate early.

PROFESSIONAL ETHICS

Be honest, fair, calm and respectful of guest privacy. Promise only what you can deliver.

GUEST COMPLAINT REPORT

REF. C-0148

Date and time

07 Oct 2026 · 08:20

Guest and room

L. Smith · Room 322

Received by

E. Smirnova, front desk

Category

Noise

Complaint: Loud voices in the corridor at 02:00. Guest could not sleep.**Action taken:** Apologised in person. Security informed. Room change offered; guest declined.**Compensation:** 10% discount on the night, approved by the duty manager.**Follow-up:** Call guest after check-out; remind night team about quiet hours.

Complaint log template

Ref	Date	Room	Complaint	Action	Compensation	Status
C-0148	07 Oct	322	Corridor noise 02:00	Apology; discount approved	10%	Closed

Role-play cards

NOISE AT NIGHT

Guest in 322 reports corridor noise at 02:00.

LATE CHECK-OUT FEE

Guest refuses the fee; says nobody explained it.

DIRTY ROOM

Guest found hair in the bathroom and wants a refund.

OBSERVER CHECKLIST

- ☐ Listens without interrupting
- ☐ Shows empathy and apologises
- ☐ Offers a solution within authority

- ☐ Escalates correctly
- ☐ Records the complaint